L-E-00530B(GSA-FSS)
May 15, 1970
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. L-E-530A
April 27, 1966

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ENVELOPE, TRANSPARENT

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification L-E-530A, dated April 27, 1966.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers transparent envelopes used to contain and protect paper, cards, and similar material.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, styles, and sizes. The transparent envelopes shall be of the following types, styles, and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Bound edges.
  Style A - With holes.
  Style B - Without hole.

Type II - Sealed edges.

1.2.2 Sizes (dimensions). (See 3.2 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing.
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Plastic. Envelopes shall be made of colorless, transparent plastic conforming to the requirements of table I (see 4.4.2.1). The plastic material shall have characteristics to assure conformance with 3.4.

TABLE I. Physical requirements for plastic

Property	Value	
	Type I	Type II
Haze, percent, maximum	6.0	6.0
Flammability, sq. in. per second, maximum	1.5	1.5
Tear resistance, pounds per specimen thickness, minimum	7.0	3.5

3.1.2 Binding. The binding shall be of black color, made from pyroxylin or vinyl-coated cotton sheeting. The finished binding shall weigh not less than seven ounces per square yard and shall have a breaking strength of not less than 30.0 pounds per inch width in both the warp and the filling directions (see 4.4.2.2).

3.1.3 Thread. The thread used for sewing shall be black, soft cotton, and shall have characteristics to assure conformance with 3.4.

3.1.4 Eyelet. The eyelet shall be of non-corrosive metal with an inside diameter of not less than 1/4 inch.

3.2 Dimensions. Unless otherwise specified, envelopes shall conform to the dimensions in table II and as ordered (see 6.2). A plus or minus tolerance of 1/16 inch shall apply to overall envelope dimensions.

TABLE II. Envelope dimensions

Overall dimensions (inches)		Type		
		I (bond edges)		II (sealed edges) with 3 holes
Length	Width	Style A with hole	Style B without hole	
8-1/4	5	---	---	X
9-1/4	5-1/2	---	---	X
10-1/2	6-1/2	X	---	---
12-1/2	10	---	X	---
13	10	X	---	---

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Type I, style A. The plastic for type I, style A, envelopes shall have a glazed finish on both sides and be not less than 0.0075 inch thick. Two sheets of plastic shall be used for each envelope. The top sheet shall be 3/4 ± 1/16 inch shorter than the bottom sheet. The plastic sheets

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

shall be securely bound together with binding on two sides and one end to form an open-end envelope. Each edge of the open end shall be bound. The extended portion of the bottom sheet shall be covered with binding. Binding shall be sewed to form a minimum 5/16-inch facing around all edges. In the extended portion shall be centrally fastened a metal eyelet to serve as a hang hole. The binding shall be stitched with stitch type 301 as described in Fed. Std. No. 751 at a distance of not less than 1/8-inch and not more than 3/16-inch from the raw edges of the binding. The stitch holes shall be not less than 1/8-inch from the unexposed edges of the plastic.

3.3.2 Type I, style B. The plastic for type I, style B, envelopes shall have a glazed finish on both sides and be not less than 0.0075 inch thick. Two sheets of plastic shall be used for each envelope. The top sheet shall be 3/16 ± 1/16 inch shorter than the bottom sheet. The plastic sheets shall be securely bound together with binding on two sides and one end to form an open-end envelope. Each edge of the open end shall be bound. Binding shall be sewed to form a 5/16-inch facing around all edges. The binding shall be stitched with stitch type 301 as described in Fed. Std. No. 751 at a distance of not less than 1/8-inch and not more than 3/16-inch from the raw edges of the binding. The stitch holes shall be not less than 1/8-inch from the unexposed edges of the plastic.

3.3.3 Type II. The plastic for type II envelopes shall have a matte finish on one side, and either a matte or glazed finish on the opposite side. The plastic shall be not less than 0.010 inch thick. Two sheets of the plastic shall be arranged so that both outside surfaces of the envelopes have a matte finish. The top sheet shall be 3/4 ± 1/16 inch shorter than the bottom sheet. The sheets shall be sealed on two sides and one end to form an open-end envelope. The extended portion of the bottom sheet shall be reinforced with plastic for a minimum of 9/16 inch from the end of the envelope. All edges of the reinforcing material shall be sealed. Three holes, having an inside minimum diameter of 1/4 inch shall be formed in the extended portion. The distance of the center of the holes to the end of the envelope shall be 5/16 ± 1/16 inch. One hole shall be equidistant from either side of the envelope. Two holes with 2-7/8 ± 1/16 inch between centers shall be located at equal distances from the centered hole. All seams at the plastic edges and around the holes shall be securely sealed by high frequency electronic sealing.

3.4 Seam strength.

3.4.1 Type I envelopes shall have a seam strength of at least 35 pounds per linear inch of seam (see 4.5.1).

3.4.2 Type II envelopes shall have a seam strength of at least 15 pounds per linear inch of seam (see 4.5.2).

3.5 Workmanship. The plastic material shall be uniform in transparency and surface finish, and shall be free from gels, scratches, cracks, blisters, pits, tears, cuts, holes, fish eyes, creases, and unmelted material. Plastic edges shall be cleanly cut, straight, and smooth. The binding material shall be uniform in color and evenly coated. Stitching and sealed seams shall be straight, of good appearance, and free from skips and gaps. The plastic of fabricated envelopes shall be flat and free from waviness. Envelopes shall be clean, well finished, free from dirt, oil, foreign matter, or other defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all transparent envelopes of the same type, style, and size offered for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling of end item for visual defects. A random sample of transparent envelopes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 inspection level II. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective for major defects and 4.0 percent defective for minor defects. The sample unit shall be one transparent envelope.

4.2.3 Sampling of end item for test. A random sample of transparent envelopes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one transparent envelope.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of interior packages, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery and selected just prior to the closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.3 Examination of end item for visual defects. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table III. Any transparent envelope in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective envelopes in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of transparent envelope defects

Defect	Category	
	Major	Minor
Not type and style specified	X	
Size (dimensions) not as specified		X
Plastic not colorless and transparent	X	
Binding not black (type I)		X
Binding not of pyroxylin or vinyl-coated cotton sheeting (type I)	X	
Thread not of black, soft cotton		X
Eyelet not of noncorrosive metal (type I, style A)	X	
Inside diameter of eyelet less than 1/4 inch (type I, style A)		X
Plastic less than minimum thickness	X	
Plastic without matte finish on one side (type II)		X
Envelope not constructed from two sheets of plastic	X	
Dimension of top sheet not as specified		X
Plastic sheets not fastened together as specified	X	
Edges not bound as specified (type I)	X	
Open-end envelope not formed	X	
Extended portion not covered or reinforced as specified	X	
Facing not as specified (type I)	X	
Eyelet not located as specified (type I, style A)		X
Binding stitching not as specified (type I)	X	
Less than three holes formed in plastic (type II)	X	
Inside diameter of holes less than 1/4 inch (type II)		X
Holes not located as specified (type II)	X	
Seams at plastic edges not sealed as specified (type II)	X	
Plastic around holes not sealed as specified (type II)	X	
Plastic not uniform in transparency and surface finish		X
Plastic edges not cleanly cut, straight, and smooth	X	
Binding material not uniform in color and evenly coated		X
Stitching and sealed seams not straight, of good appearance and free from skips and gaps	X	
Envelopes not clean and well finished		X
Plastic of fabricated envelopes not flat and not free from waivness	X	
Any dirt, oil, foreign matter, gels, scratches, cracks, blisters, pits, tears, cuts, holes, fish eyes, creases, unmelted material, or other defects affecting appearance or serviceability	X	

4.4 Sampling and testing of components. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications and standards to the extent specified, or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.4.1 Sampling of components. The lot shall consist of one shipment of plastic of the same description or binding material received at one time from one source of supply and shall be expressed in yards of plastic by the width and yards of binding material by the width, as applicable. The sample unit shall be one square yard of plastic and one yard by the width of binding material. The sample units shall be taken from each lot of plastic and binding material in accordance with table IV. There shall be no failure to meet the sample unit or lot average requirements.

TABLE IV. Sample size

Yards of plastic by the width or yards of binding material by the width in the lot	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.2 Testing of components. Samples, taken in accordance with 4.4.1, shall be subjected to the following tests. Specimens shall be conditioned at 23° ± 1.1°C. (73.5° ± 2°F.) and 50 ± 4 percent relative humidity for 48 hours.

4.4.2.1 Plastic. The plastic tests shall be made in accordance with the following methods described in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 406:

Method	Title
3022	Haze
2022	Flammability
1121	Tear resistance

In conducting the test for tear resistance, method 1121, the tear strength shall be reported in pounds per specimen thickness.

4.4.2.2 Binding material. Breaking strength and weight of binding material shall be determined in accordance with the following methods described in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191:

Method	Title
5100	Strength and Elongation, Break- of Woven Cloth; Grab Method.
5041	Weight of Cloth; Small Specimen Method.

4.5 Testing of end item.

4.5.1 Type I. A static-weighing constant-rate of clamp separation machine shall be used for this test. Each clamp shall have two jaws. The face of one jaw of each clamp shall be 1 inch in width, and the face of the other jaw of each clamp shall be 1-1/2 inches or more in width. The distance between the clamps shall be 4 inches at the start of the test.

From each sample envelope, cut a specimen strip 6 inches long by 3 inches wide with the bound seam 3 inches in length and midway of the 6-inch dimension.

Secure a specimen with the seam midway between the clamps. Apply force perpendicular to the seam at a constant rate of 2 inches per minute until failure of the seam or the plastic material. Record the number of pounds of force at failure. Breaking of plastic material prior to seam failure shall constitute failure of envelope.

4.5.2 Type II. A static-weighing constant-rate of clamp separation machine shall be used for this test. Each clamp shall have two jaws. The face of one jaw of each clamp shall be 1 inch in width, and the face of the other jaw of each clamp shall be 1-1/2 inches or more in width. The distance between the clamps shall be 4 inches at the start of the test.

From each sample envelope, cut a specimen strip 6 inches long by 1 inch wide with the sealed seam 1 inch in length and midway of the 6-inch dimension.

Secure a specimen with the seam midway between the clamps. Apply force perpendicular to the seam at a constant rate of 2 inches per minute until failure of the seam or the plastic material. Record the number of pounds of force at failure. Breaking of plastic material prior to seam failure shall constitute failure of envelope.

4.6 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table V.

TABLE V. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Bulging or distortion of container. Number per container is more or less than required.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred envelopes of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636; PPP-B-566, style IV, type A, class a; PPP-B-665, style A; or PPP-B-676, type I. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. One hundred envelopes of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, style IV, type A, class a; PPP-B-665, style A; or PPP-B-676, type I. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The envelopes shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Envelopes, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3; PPP-B-591, class II; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s; or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The fiberboard boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. Strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Envelopes, packaged as specified in 5.1, in sizes 8-1/4 by 5 and 9-1/4 by 5-1/2, shall be packed 12 packages per shipping container; sizes 10-1/2 by 6-1/2, 12-1/2 by 10, and 13 by 10 shall be packed 5 packages per shipping container. Containers shall be close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant boxes. When specified, fiberboard shipping containers shall conform to PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s (see 6.2).

5.2.3 Level C. The envelopes shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying the common carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack. (Civil agency procurements.) The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 (see 6.3).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The transparent envelopes covered by this specification are intended to contain and protect blue prints, work orders, invoices, routing data, and similar material.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, style, and size required (see 1.2.1, 1.2.2, and 3.2).
(c) Whether shipping containers shall conform to PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s (see 5.2.2.1).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, or shipment to eventual user.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4 Military agencies. Level B preservation and packaging is intended to provide limited but economical protection and should be specified only when it is determined that transparent envelopes will be held in covered storage.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 69

Review activities:

Army - GL, SM
Navy - SA

User activities:

Army - MD, MV
Navy - MC

CIVIL AGENCY INTEREST:

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Interested activity:

Com-NBS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:10Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.